EXERCISE 1

Read the following passage below and write an outline of it.

Noise pollution is one nuisance that has been ignored or downplayed by society for a very long time and in view of that many Ghanaians have come to accept excessive noise as a way of life. On our streets, hawkers of traditional medicine use microphones to shout above the cacophony of noise produced by vehicles to get the attention of passers-by, while roadside preachers actually mount speakers in the early hours of the day and contribute to noise on our streets. Drinking bars located in the same areas also try to outdo one another by raising the volume of their music to a crescendo which becomes irritating to the ears. The worst offenders when it comes to noise in neighborhoods are churches and mosques. While the churches tune up the volumes on their amplifiers to full blast, no matter the time of day of worship, some mosques have positioned their horn speakers at the top of the buildings and contribute to noise-making in otherwise quiet communities during the call to prayer known as adhan. However, many studies conducted have shown that noise at certain levels or decibels, as they are measured, is very injurious to health, apart from the inconvenience and distortion it causes. Although there have been many instances of residents reporting the unbearable noise they have to endure from certain quarters to the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) and the local authorities, most of the reports have not been addressed and the best action that has been taken is normally a reprimand or a letter from EPA or the local authorities to the offenders. A letter from the EPA was given to some churches. The churches were expected to pay some amount of money for damages caused as compensation for making excessive noise. It is hoped that the EPA and local authorities will implement

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